

The Apocalypse of Paul

17,19-24,9

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[...] 183 the road. And [he spoke to him], saying, “[By which] road [shall I go] up to [Jerusalem]?” The little child [replied, saying], “Say your name, so that [I may show] you the road.” [The little child] knew [who Paul was]. He wished to make conversation with him through his words [in order that] he might find an excuse for speaking with him.

The little child spoke, saying, “I know who you are, Paul. You are he who was blessed from his mother’s womb. For I have [come] to you that you may [go up to Jerusalem] to your fellow [apostles. And] for this reason [you were called. And] I am the [Spirit who accompanies] you. Let [your mind awaken, Paul], with [...]. For [...] whole which [...] among the [principalities and] these authorities and archangels and powers and the whole race of demons, [...] the one that reveals bodies to a soul-seed.”

And after he brought that speech to an end, he spoke, saying to me, “Let your mind awaken, Paul, and see that this mountain upon which you are standing is the mountain of Jericho, so that you may know the hidden things in those that are visible. Now it is to the twelve apostles that you shall go, for they are elect spirits, and they will greet you.” He raised his eyes and saw them greeting him.

Then the Holy [Spirit] who was speaking with [him] caught him up on high to the third heaven, and he passed beyond to the fourth [heaven]. The [Holy] Spirit spoke to him, saying, “Look and see your [likeness] upon the earth.” And he [looked] down and saw those [who were upon] the earth. He stared [and saw] those who were upon the [. . . Then he] gazed [down and] saw the [twelve] apostles [at] his right [and] at his left in the creation; and the Spirit was going before them.

But I saw in the fourth heaven according to class—I saw the angels resembling gods, the angels bringing a soul out of the land of the dead. They placed it at the gate of the fourth heaven. And the angels were whipping it. The soul spoke, saying, “What sin was it that I committed in the world?” The toll-collector who dwells in the fourth heaven replied, saying, “It was not right to commit all those lawless deeds that are in the world of the dead.” The soul replied, saying, “Bring witnesses! Let them [show] you in what body I committed lawless deeds. [Do you wish] to bring a book [to read from]?”

And the three witnesses came. The first spoke, saying, “Was I [not in] the body the second hour [...]? I rose up against you until [you fell] into anger [and rage] and envy.” And the second spoke, saying, “Was I not in the world? And I entered at the fifth hour, and I saw you and desired you. And behold, then, now I charge you with the murders you committed.” The third spoke, saying, “Did I not come to you at the twelfth hour of the day when the sun was about to set? I gave you darkness until you should accomplish your sins.” When the soul heard these things, it gazed downward in sorrow. And then it gazed upward. It was cast down. The soul that had been cast down [went] to [a] body which had been prepared [for it. And] behold [its] witnesses were finished.

[Then I gazed] upward and [saw the] Spirit saying [to me], “Paul, come! [Proceed toward] me!” Then as I [went], the gate opened, [and] I went up to the fifth [heaven]. And I saw my fellow apos-

bles [going with me] while the Spirit accompanied us.

And I saw a great angel in the fifth heaven holding an iron rod in his hand. There were three other angels with him, and I stared into their faces. But they were rivalling each other, with whips in their hands, goading the souls on to the judgment. But I went with the Spirit and the gate opened for me.

Then we went up to the sixth heaven. And I saw my fellow apostles going with me, and the Holy Spirit was leading me before them. And I gazed up on high and saw a great light shining down on the sixth heaven. I spoke, saying to the toll-collector who was in the sixth heaven, “[Open] to me and the [Holy] Spirit [who is] before [me].” He opened [to me].

[Then we went] up to the seventh [heaven and I saw] an old man [...] light [and whose garment] was white. [His throne], which is in the seventh heaven, [was] brighter than the sun by [seven] times.

The old man spoke, saying to [me], “Where are you going, Paul, O blessed one and the one who was set apart from his mother’s womb?” But I looked at the Spirit, and he was nodding his head, saying to me, “Speak with him!” And I replied, saying to the old man, “I am going to the place from which I came.” And the old man responded to me, “Where are you from?” But I replied, saying, “I am going down to the world of the dead in order to lead captive the captivity that was led captive in the captivity of Babylon.” The old man replied to me, saying, “How will you be able to get away from me? Look and see the principalities and authorities.” [The] Spirit spoke, saying, “Give him [the] sign that you have, and [he will] open for you.” And then I gave [him] the sign. He turned his face downwards to his creation and to those who are his own authorities.

And then the (seventh) heaven opened and we went up to [the] Ogdoad. And I saw the twelve apostles. They greeted me, and we went up to the ninth heaven. I greeted all those who were in the ninth heaven, and we went up to the tenth heaven. And I greeted my fellow spirits.

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